Saiteja Utpala

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Github
Google Scholar

Education

IIT Kanpur, UP, India *2018 - 2020*
Masters in Computer Science and Engineering
Academic Excellence Award

SV Univeristy, Tirupathi, India *2013 - 2017*
Bachelors in Mechanical Engineering
First Class with Distinction

Work Experience

MBZUAI, Abu Dhabi, UAE *Jan 2026 - Now*
Researcher, diffusion language models

Princeton University, USA *Sept 2025 - Dec 2026*
Researcher Engineer

Entelligence AI, Remote, India *Mar 2025 - Sept 2025*
Research SDE

Microsoft Research, Bangalore, India *Feb 2024 - Feb 2025*
Research SDE, **Github Copilot** Workspace Team

Wadhwani AI, Delhi, India *Apr 2023 - Jan 2024*
Associate ML scientist

Geomstats, Open Source, US *Dec 2021- Dec 2022*
Maintainer and Lead Engineer

UCSB, California, US *Dec 2021- Jun 2022*
Staff Research Associate

Mastercard, Pune, India *Aug 2020 - Dec 2021*
Software Development Engineer

Publications

9. **Looped Uniform Diffusion Language Models**
   Topics: Diffusion language models, Recurrent Depth, Flop-Efficient training
   Saiteja Utpala, Chieh-Hsin Lai, Yuki Mitsufuji and Praneeth Vepakomma. *Preprint.*

8. **Towards a science of AI agent reliability**
   Topics: AI Agents, Reliability
   Stephan Rabanser, Sayash Kapoor, Peter Kirgis, Kangheng Liu, **Saiteja Utpala**, Arvind Narayanan. *Accepted at **ICML 2026**.*

7. **RWKV-7 "Goose" with Expressive Dynamic State Evolution**
   Topics: Linear Attention, LLMs
   Bo Peng, Ruichong Zhang, Daniel Goldstein, Eric Alcaide, Haowen Hou, Janna Lu, William Merrill, Guangyu Song, Kaifeng Tan, **Saiteja Utpala**, Nathan Wilce, Johan S. Wind, Tianyi Wu, Daniel Wuttke, Christian Zhou-Zheng. *Accepted at **COLM, 2025**.*

6. **MMTEB: Massive Multilingual Embedding Benchmark**
   Topics: Embeddings, Multilinguality, Retrieval
   Kenneth Enevoldsen, Isaac Chung, Imene Kerboua, Márton Kardos, Ashwin Mathur, David Stap, Jay Gala, Wissam Siblini, Dominik Krzeminski, Genta Indra Winata, Saba Sturua, **Saiteja Utpala**, Mathieu Ciancone, ..., Niklas Muennighoff. *Accepted at **ICLR, 2024**.*

5. **Language Agnostic Code Embeddings.**
   Topics: Code LLMs; Retrieval; Zero Shot Alignment
   Saiteja Utpala, Alex Gu, Pin Yu Chen. *Accepted at **NAACL, 2024**.*

4. **Locally Differentially Private Document Generation Using Zero Shot Prompting.**
   Topics: LLMs; De-anonymization Attacks; Private Documents.
   Saiteja Utpala, Sara Hooker, Pin Yu Chen. *Accepted at **EMNLP (Findings), 2023**.*

3. **Shrinkage Estimation of Higher Order Bochner Integrals**.
   Topics: Learning Theory; Concentration Inequalities; Functional Analysis.
   Saiteja Utpala and Bharat K. Sriperumbudur. *Accepted at **Bernoulli, 2023**.*

2. **Improved Differentialy Private Riemannian Optimization: Fast Sampling and Variance Reduction**.
   Topics: Differential Privacy, Non-Convex Optimization, Riemannian Optimization.
   Saiteja Utpala, Andi Han, Pratik Jawanpuria, Bamdev Mishra. *Accepted at **TMLR, 2023**.*

1. **Differentially Private Fréchet Mean on the Manifold of SPD Matrices**.
   Topics: Differential Privacy, Geometric Machine Learning.
   Saiteja Utpala, Praneeth Vepakomma, Nina Miolane. *Accepted at **TMLR, 2023**.*

Selected Awards and Honors

- Won UK AISI Bounty of £20,025 for designing and implementing dangerous capability evaluations of LLM agents. *2025*
- Won METR TaskBounty of $70,214 for designing and implementing ML R&D tasks for evaluation of LLM agents. *2024*
- Won $5,000 for designing one of the Top 50 Hardest Questions for Humanity's Last Exam on Differential Geometry. *2024*
- Won $1,700 for designing one of the 300 most innovative questions for Epoch AI's Frontier Math Benchmark. *2024*
- Won $750 for 2nd place at the ICLR 2021 Computational Geometry & Topology Challenge. *2021*
- Achieved 10/10 in Machine Learning and Statistics Courses at IIT Kanpur. 2020
- Received the Academic Excellence Award for exceptional performance in 2018-19 academic session at IIT Kanpur. *2019*